

Mary Tells Joseph / It's Not Mine

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CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 6 — MARY & JOSEPH / “IT’S NOT MINE”

SCENE 6 — CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 5

No blackout.

The rhythm that filled the workshop has disappeared with Joseph’s friends.

The unfinished table remains. Joseph still wears the satchel Mary made for him.

Mary and Joseph are alone.

JOSEPH

Mary...

Beat.

JOSEPH

What happened?

Mary remembers Shira’s instruction: Start with the truth.

MARY

I need to tell you something.

JOSEPH

All right.

MARY

I need you to listen.

JOSEPH

I’m listening.

MARY

All the way through.

That changes him slightly.

JOSEPH

Mary...

MARY

Please.

Joseph nods.

JOSEPH

All right.

Mary gathers herself.

MARY

I'm going to have a child.

SILENCE

Joseph looks at her. For a moment the sentence does not fit anywhere in his understanding.

JOSEPH

What?

MARY

I'm with child.

A tiny disbelieving breath escapes him.

JOSEPH

No.

MARY

Joseph—

JOSEPH

No, I mean—

He stops. Tries again.

JOSEPH

Are you certain?

MARY

Yes.

JOSEPH

Certain.

MARY

Yes.

Joseph's first instinct is not accusation. It is protection.

JOSEPH

Did someone hurt you?

MARY

No.

JOSEPH

Did someone force you?

MARY

No.

JOSEPH

Are you protecting someone?

MARY

No.

Joseph searches her face.

JOSEPH

Then help me understand.

MARY

I'm trying.

JOSEPH

Then tell me what happened.

THE IMPOSSIBLE EXPLANATION

MARY

A messenger came to me.

JOSEPH

A messenger.

MARY

From God.

Joseph goes still.

JOSEPH

Mary.

MARY

His name was Gabriel.

JOSEPH

You're saying an angel came to you.

MARY

Yes.

JOSEPH

And told you—

MARY

That I would have a son.

JOSEPH

And the father?

MARY

Joseph—

JOSEPH

What did he say?

MARY

That the child comes from God.

Joseph turns away. Not in disgust. He simply needs somewhere else to look.

JOSEPH

Listen to what you're asking me to believe.

MARY

I have.

JOSEPH

No one else saw him?

MARY

No.

JOSEPH

He came to you alone.

MARY

Yes.

JOSEPH

And then he was gone.

MARY

Yes.

Joseph turns back.

JOSEPH

So all I have is your word.

MARY

Yes.

Beat.

MARY

I know.

JOSEPH

You know?

MARY

I know exactly what that means here.

The village outside the workshop remains ordinary and unchanged.

HE WANTS TO BELIEVE HER

MARY

You know me.

JOSEPH

That's why this hurts.

Mary takes that in.

MARY

Then believe me.

JOSEPH

I want to.

Beat.

JOSEPH

I want to believe you.

MARY

Then do.

JOSEPH

Mary, I can't make something make sense because I want it to.

MARY

It didn't make sense to me either.

JOSEPH

But now it does?

MARY

No.

That surprises him.

MARY

Not all of it.

JOSEPH

Then how can you stand there and be so certain?

MARY

Because I know what happened to me.

JOSEPH

And I know what this looks like.

MARY

Those are not the same thing.

JOSEPH

They are from where I'm standing.

Mary steps closer.

MARY

Look at me.

Joseph does.

MARY

Have I ever given you a reason not to trust me?

JOSEPH

No.

MARY

Then trust me now.

Joseph wants to. That is visible before he answers.

JOSEPH

I don't know how.

THE TABLE

Joseph turns away and finds the unfinished table in front of him.

His hand lands on it almost without thought.

JOSEPH

I was building this today.

MARY

I know.

JOSEPH

Six seats.

A small, broken breath that almost remembers the joke.

JOSEPH

Maybe eight.

MARY

Joseph—

JOSEPH

The window. Your garden. That ridiculous fence I'm apparently rebuilding for the rest of my life.

Mary's eyes fill. These were happy things only hours ago.

JOSEPH

I could see it.

MARY

So could I.

JOSEPH

I knew where the door went. Where the table went. How much room we'd need.

He looks at her.

JOSEPH

I had a plan.

MARY

I know.

JOSEPH

And now I don't know what any of it is.

MARY

Neither do I.

JOSEPH

But you're asking me to live inside it anyway.

MARY

I'm asking you to believe that I'm telling you the truth.

THE BREAK

Joseph searches for one final explanation.

JOSEPH

Is there anything you haven't told me?

MARY

No.

JOSEPH

Anything.

MARY

No.

JOSEPH

Something you're afraid I won't forgive?

MARY

Joseph, no.

JOSEPH

Because I would rather hear something terrible that I can understand than—

He cannot finish.

MARY

I don't have an easier story to give you.

Joseph looks at her.

JOSEPH

I wish you did.

MARY

You think I betrayed you.

JOSEPH

I think something happened.

MARY

Something did happen.

JOSEPH

Something I understand.

MARY

That doesn't make it true.

JOSEPH

And saying an angel came doesn't make this make sense!

His first true emotional break. Silence immediately after it.

Joseph regrets the volume, but not the confusion.

MARY

I know.

JOSEPH

No, you believe.

MARY

Yes.

JOSEPH

And I don't know how.

His eyes drop—not accusingly, but inevitably—to the reality of the child.

JOSEPH

The child...

Beat.

JOSEPH

It's not mine.

SILENCE

MARY

No.

Joseph closes his eyes.

MARY

But that doesn't mean—

JOSEPH

It's not mine.

MUSIC BEGINS

"IT'S NOT MINE"

The song grows directly out of Joseph attempting to restore order.

A fractured version of the Brotherhood rhythm appears.

BANG. BANG. SCRAPE. CLAP. STOMP.

Joseph reaches instinctively for a tool.

JOSEPH

Rhythmically

Measure twice...

He attempts the old pattern.

BANG. BANG.

Stops.

Nothing fits anymore.

VERSE 1 — WHAT HE KNOWS

Joseph's language stays concrete.

He knows

what they promised;

what they planned;

what he built;

what the evidence appears to mean.

The musical thought moves toward

I know the road.

I know the plan.

I know what should have been.

But this child is not mine.

Mary tries to reach him from inside the number.

She does not overpower him.

CHORUS — “IT’S NOT MINE”

*At first, the phrase means only
the child.*

Then the meaning begins expanding.

It's not mine.

This isn't what we planned.

This isn't what I built.

VERSE 2 — THE FUTURE COLLAPSES

*The “My Beloved” motif appears underneath—distorted or incomplete.
Joseph looks at the table.*

The phrase now means

The home I imagined isn't mine.

The future I understood isn't mine.

The story I thought I could control isn't mine.

Keep this section emotionally direct rather than wordy.

MARY'S SECTION

Mary finally gets musical space.

Her territory

I didn't choose the fear.

I didn't choose the cost.

I didn't choose to hurt you.

I chose to trust God.

Joseph catches one word

JOSEPH

Spoken/sung

You chose this.

MARY

I chose to believe God.

JOSEPH

And now you're asking me to choose it too.

That is the bridge.

Do not add another long argument inside the song.

FINAL CHORUS

The first "It's not mine" was almost an accusation.

The final one is loss.

Joseph looks at the table.

Then Mary.

JOSEPH

Quietly

It's not mine...

The music ends unresolved.

SILENCE.

AFTERMATH

Mary and Joseph are now farther apart than when the scene began.

MARY

Joseph...

He cannot look at her yet.

MARY

What happens now?

JOSEPH

I don't know.

MARY

Please don't leave.

Joseph looks at her.

JOSEPH

What would you have me do?

MARY

Stay.

JOSEPH

And pretend I understand?

MARY

No.

JOSEPH

Pretend I believe something I don't?

MARY

No.

JOSEPH

Then what?

MARY

Believe me.

Long beat.

JOSEPH

I want to.

Mary waits.

JOSEPH

I don't know how.

JOSEPH'S CHOICE

The anger has burned away. What remains is grief.

JOSEPH

I won't shame you.

Mary looks at him.

JOSEPH

I won't make this public.

MARY

Joseph—

JOSEPH

Whatever people say about me, I won't hand them something they can use against you.

MARY

Then don't leave me.

That nearly undoes him.

JOSEPH

I can't marry you.

SILENCE

MARY

You said whatever comes.

Joseph looks at her.

MARY

You said you'd walk with me.

JOSEPH

I know.

MARY

Then walk with me now.

Joseph cannot.

JOSEPH

When I said that...

He looks at the table.

JOSEPH

I thought I knew what "whatever comes" meant.

MARY

So did I.

That lands differently. Neither of them planned this.

JOSEPH

You still said yes.

MARY

Yes.

JOSEPH

And you believe.

MARY

Yes.

JOSEPH

I don't.

There is the wall between them.

FINAL EXCHANGE

Joseph moves toward the exit.

He passes the unfinished table and stops. His hand rests on it once. He does not destroy it, overturn it, or remove anything from it.

MARY

Joseph.

He stops.

MARY

Please.

Beat.

MARY

Believe me.

Joseph remains facing away.

JOSEPH

I don't know how.

Joseph exits.

Mary remains.

Do not have her collapse. She is devastated, but her yes still exists.

Her eyes find the unfinished table. She touches the edge Joseph had been working on.

A nearly imperceptible fragment of "Chosen" may return not triumphant, simply present.

Mary steadies herself.

The warm workshop environment remains. Nothing outside has changed.

END SCENE 6